

BuyWise Overview

Current product status as of May 13, 2026

BuyWise is currently a photo-first product analyzer. The active user flow is no longer based on pasted product links or preset product guide cards. Users upload screenshots or product photos, BuyWise analyzes what is visible, and the app returns a cautious deal verdict.

What BuyWise Does Today

- Lets users upload, drag and drop, or take one or more product/listing photos.
- Accepts image uploads only, including marketplace screenshots, retail product pages, checkout screens, and product sale photos.
- Uses OpenAI vision through a server route to extract product name, price if visible, source, condition, visible details, and risk warnings.
- Rejects uploads that do not look like a product for sale, and rejects unsafe or inappropriate products instead of scoring them.
- Allows the user to manually type a price. If they do, BuyWise treats that price as confirmed and sets price confidence to 100.
- Scores valid uploads with a strict deal score, recommendation, market position label, risk level, confidence level, suggested offer/buy range, subscores, red flags, pros, cons, and alternatives when available.
- Lets users save verdicts to their account when Supabase auth is configured.
- Can publish approved extracted product cards to the Search page for 24 hours. Raw uploaded screenshots remain private.

What BuyWise Does Not Do Yet

- It does not actively analyze pasted product links anymore. Link analysis has been retired from the active code path.
- It does not use fake preset product cards as the source of Search results.
- It does not guarantee live market comparisons unless provider credentials are configured and enough comparable results are returned.
- It does not publicly expose raw uploaded screenshots because those may contain seller names, addresses, account data, or other private details.
- It does not yet crop or redact safe product thumbnails for the Search feed.
- It does not scrape Facebook Marketplace or bypass retailer protections.
- It does not pretend to know a market price when the app cannot verify one.

Main User Flow

- The user opens the homepage or Analyze Listing page.
- The user uploads one or more images using drag/drop, file picker, or camera capture.
- The user optionally enters the price and extra notes.

- The app sends the photos to /api/analyze-photos.
- The server validates file type and size, runs OpenAI vision analysis, and checks whether the upload is sale-related and appropriate.
- If the upload is invalid, the app stops and shows a clear rejection message.
- If a price is missing, the app asks the user to enter the price before scoring.
- If the upload is valid and priced, BuyWise calculates a strict deal verdict.
- If Supabase service-role storage is configured and confidence is high enough, BuyWise stores private image paths and publishes a safe extracted product card to Search for 24 hours.
- The user can save the verdict to their account or local device.

Analyzer Output

The verdict page is designed to be strict and easy to read. It intentionally avoids sections that made the old analyzer feel cluttered, including Trust signals, Questions to ask, and Compared against.

- Main Deal Score out of 100.
- Recommendation: Great deal, Fair price, Overpriced, Risky purchase, or Avoid.
- Market position label such as Excellent Deal, Strong Deal, Fair Market Price, High Risk Bargain, Suspicious Listing, Needs More Proof, or Unverified Price.
- Confidence level: High, Medium, or Low, with reasons.
- Suggested offer or buy range. If low and high are the same, the app shows one number.
- Subscores for Price / Value, Trust / Safety, Condition, Market Fit, and Confidence.
- Why this score breakdown.
- Red flags detected from visible text/details.
- Pros and cons.
- Better retail and resale alternatives if configured market providers return meaningful comparable results.

Search Tab

Search is now a temporary feed of approved product cards extracted from photo analyses. It is not a static catalog and should not show preset products.

- Search calls /api/photo-feed.
- The API only returns rows where visible_in_search is true, moderation_status is approved, and expires_at is still in the future.
- Each card can show product title, price, detected source, condition, verdict, score, and upload time/expiration.
- Original uploaded photos are not returned publicly because safe thumbnail redaction is not implemented yet.
- Rows are designed to expire after 24 hours.

Data And Storage

- Supabase Auth handles account creation, login, logout, and user sessions.
- Supabase saved_items stores saved verdicts for logged-in users. Local storage is still used as a fallback when logged out.
- Supabase Storage bucket buywise-photo-uploads stores raw uploaded images privately.
- photo_analyses stores image paths, extracted product fields, score/verdict fields, moderation status, visible_in_search, expires_at, created_at, and optional user_id.
- Public Search does not directly query the table from the client. It goes through a controlled API route using the service role key on the server.

Required Environment Variables

- NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_URL and NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY for client auth and saved-item syncing.
- SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY for server-side private uploads, photo analysis rows, feed publishing, and cleanup.
- OPENAI_API_KEY for photo analysis.
- OPENAI_VISION_MODEL, currently defaulting to gpt-4.1-mini if unset.
- CRON_SECRET for the cleanup endpoint.
- Optional: EBAY_CLIENT_ID, EBAY_CLIENT_SECRET, EBAY_MARKETPLACE_ID, and BEST_BUY_API_KEY for market comparison checks.

Market Comparison Status

The market check is intentionally conservative. BuyWise searches configured providers using the extracted product name. If at least a few comparable prices are found with enough confidence, it computes an approximate market range. If not, the app says the market price is not verified yet and keeps the score cautious.

- eBay Browse API support exists when eBay credentials are configured.
- Best Buy Product API support exists when a Best Buy API key is configured.
- Amazon, Walmart, Target, B&H, StockX, GOAT, and other sources are not reliable active providers in this version unless future adapters are added.
- The app should not fake market prices or alternatives.

Retired Link Analyzer

The old link analyzer was removed from the active app. It accepted pasted links, tried provider lookup, and fell back to public metadata/HTML parsing. It was retired because many major sites block price extraction or expose incomplete data, which made the experience feel unreliable. Restoration notes live in docs/retired-link-analyzer.md. The last known commit before removal is 0f5d10b.

Current Limitations And Honest Notes

- The analyzer quality depends on OpenAI vision reading the uploaded images correctly.

- Blurry screenshots, cropped images, missing prices, or missing product details reduce confidence.
- Manual price entry solves price confidence but does not make overall confidence 100 because product identity, condition, and market comparison can still be uncertain.
- Search feed publishing depends on Supabase service-role configuration and private storage.
- Market comparisons are limited to configured providers and available comparable results.
- Safe public thumbnails are intentionally withheld until there is cropping/redaction support.
- The product is now much closer to the desired core idea, but it still needs real-world testing with many screenshot types before it should be considered fully reliable.